

limited income, we need to focus on one at a time. And if you're only going to focus on one at a time, choose the one with the biggest impact. Often this means paying off debt, but it doesn't have to be. It could also be saving for an event, like a wedding or birth of a baby, or investing for retirement. Everyone's financial goal will look different. Choose the one that gets you closer to what you love.

Once you've defined the financial goals that matter most, you can move on to the tangible things you like to buy. To define the things you value most in this category, it can actually be helpful to start with what matters least. Go back through your 90-day transaction inventory and identify the purchases that didn't fulfill the need you wanted or make you feel the way you intended. Look for subscriptions you don't use or didn't realize you had and purchases you don't remember making. These are good indicators that those purchases are not things you love. Some other questions you can ask about your purchases that can help you identify things that don't matter are:

Did I feel pressured to buy or contribute to this?

Was the act of purchasing more important than the purchase itself?

Was the purchase influenced by some unattainable standard, or something seen on social media?

With physical pen and paper, make a list, a commitment rather, of five to ten things you decide you no longer value, and as a result will no longer spend on for the foreseeable future. Your list should be short, realistic, and simple to follow through on. The list should not include your mortgage or rent payment—please keep a roof over your head. That said, you may find that your list gives you inspiration to be creative with expenses that seem difficult to change. For example, maybe you find you don't want to be a homeowner anymore, but selling isn't the best decision for you right now. Simply identifying what you don't value could lead you on the path to rent your home out and go rent somewhere else you truly want to be. This example may feel extreme, but we want to show you that when you start getting curious, specifically about what you've assumed is set in stone, you can start to ask questions and come up with creative options to spend in greater alignment with what you value.

Next, you can start to explore the things you do value. Go through your 90-day transaction inventory and look for the things you bought that you loved and still love three months later. Things that fully met an internal need or, if you're a Marie Kondo fan, sparked joy for you. Make note of all